Project brief

DSO Daddy

A conversational AI prototype for international-student questions at IWU.

Overview

DSO Daddy explores conversational support for international students studying at Indiana Wesleyan University. The idea grew from familiarity with questions about student visas and studying in the United States.

The project

The Lovable-based prototype offers a chat input and topic entry points for Visa & I-20, Admissions, CPT & OPT, and Student life.

My contribution

I contributed to ideation, choosing the problem, testing prompts, and planning the assistant.

The goal

Make international-student information easier to approach through a conversational interface, with referral to a designated school official or immigration lawyer when needed.

My approach

Choose the problem and scope. I helped select international-student support as the problem, with an initial focus on student-related visa questions before broader work-visa topics.

Plan guardrails and escalation. During ideation, I focused on the assistant's boundaries: it should answer questions without giving legal advice or taking action on behalf of a designated school official. Deciding when it should escalate a question was one of the most challenging planning decisions. The intended role was to provide information and refer users to a DSO when necessary.

Explore prompts. The recorded activity used ChatGPT, Claude, and Copilot with the initial question: "What documents are needed for travel on OPT?" Other questions covered entering the United States and transferring schools.

Select a platform. Deployment was another challenge to work through. We explored Chatbase before settling on Lovable because it made prototyping and deployment easier.

Tools & technologies

ChatGPT, Claude, and Copilot: initial prompt exploration.

Lovable: prototype development and hosting.

Chatbase: platform exploration.

Why it matters

What makes it useful

A focused conversational interface brings student-support topics together with an initial question set and referral guidance.

Who it helps

International students seeking information about studying at IWU and student-related visa topics.

Current limitations

DSO Daddy is an independent student prototype, not an official IWU service or a source of legal advice. The available documentation does not establish answer accuracy, complete official-source coverage, a retrieval architecture, tested escalation behavior, comparative model performance, or measured student outcomes.

Sources

DSO Daddy planning notes (unpublished), my account of assistant planning and platform selection, and the DSO Daddy prototype, hosted on Lovable.

Explore the prototype

Live prototype: https://iwu-chatbot.lovable.app/